National Transportation Safety Board
Aviation Accident Final Report

Location:	Calexico, CA	**Accident Number:**	SEA08CA034
Date & Time:	11/19/2007, 1138 PST	**Registration:**	N2237D
Aircraft:	Ayres S2R-G1	**Aircraft Damage:**	Substantial
Defining Event:		**Injuries:**	1 None
Flight Conducted Under:	Part 137: Agricultural		

Analysis

The pilot reported that after landing and getting the tailwheel on the ground the airplane began to drift to the right. The pilot corrected to the left and managed to get the airplane back to the center of the runway, but the airplane continued to the left as the pilot was late in getting the stick far enough forward to unlock the tailwheel. The pilot stated, "...I was on the [left] edge of the runway, which is the edge of the ditch. I started to add power to go around, but the left [landing] gear fell off the edge of the drain pulling the plane into the ditch." The pilot reported that at the time of the landing the wind was calm.

Probable Cause and Findings

The National Transportation Safety Board determines the probable cause(s) of this accident to be: The pilot's failure to maintain directional control while landing. A factor in the accident was the close proximity of the drainage ditch to the edge of the private airstrip's runway.

Findings

Occurrence #1: LOSS OF CONTROL - ON GROUND/WATER
Phase of Operation: LANDING - ROLL

Findings
1. (C) DIRECTIONAL CONTROL - NOT MAINTAINED - PILOT IN COMMAND

Occurrence #2: ON GROUND/WATER ENCOUNTER WITH TERRAIN/WATER
Phase of Operation: LANDING - ROLL

Findings
2. (F) TERRAIN CONDITION - DITCH

Factual Information

Pilot Information

Certificate:	Airline Transport; Flight Instructor; Commercial	**Age:**	62, Male
Airplane Rating(s):	Multi-engine Land; Single-engine Land; Single-engine Sea	**Seat Occupied:**	
Other Aircraft Rating(s):	None	**Restraint Used:**	Seatbelt, Shoulder harness
Instrument Rating(s):	Airplane	**Second Pilot Present:**	
Instructor Rating(s):		**Toxicology Performed:**	
Medical Certification:	Class 2	**Last FAA Medical Exam:**	03/01/2007
Occupational Pilot:		**Last Flight Review or Equivalent:**	
Flight Time:	8820 hours (Total, all aircraft), 95 hours (Total, this make and model), 96 hours (Last 90 days, all aircraft), 35 hours (Last 30 days, all aircraft)		

Aircraft and Owner/Operator Information

Aircraft Make:	Ayres	**Registration:**	N2237D
Model/Series:	S2R-G1	**Aircraft Category:**	Airplane
Year of Manufacture:		**Amateur Built:**	No
Airworthiness Certificate:	Restricted	**Serial Number:**	G1-104
Landing Gear Type:	Tailwheel	**Seats:**	
Date/Type of Last Inspection:		**Certified Max Gross Wt.:**	
Time Since Last Inspection:		**Engines:**	1 Turbo Prop
Airframe Total Time:		**Engine Manufacturer:**	Airesearch
ELT:		**Engine Model/Series:**	TPE-331
Registered Owner:	Frontier Agricultural Service, Inc.	**Rated Power:**	
Operator:	Frontier Agricultural Service, Inc.	**Operating Certificate(s) Held:**	None

Meteorological Information and Flight Plan

Conditions at Accident Site:	Visual Conditions	**Condition of Light:**	Day
Observation Facility, Elevation:		**Distance from Accident Site:**	
Observation Time:		**Direction from Accident Site:**	
Lowest Cloud Condition:	Clear	**Visibility**	10 Miles
Lowest Ceiling:	None	**Visibility (RVR):**	
Wind Speed/Gusts:	Calm /	**Turbulence Type Forecast/Actual:**	/
Wind Direction:		**Turbulence Severity Forecast/Actual:**	/
Altimeter Setting:		**Temperature/Dew Point:**	27°C / 5°C
Precipitation and Obscuration:	No Obscuration; No Precipitation		
Departure Point:	Calexico, CA (0945)	**Type of Flight Plan Filed:**	None
Destination:	Calexico, CA	**Type of Clearance:**	None
Departure Time:	PST	**Type of Airspace:**	

Airport Information

Airport:	Private Airstrip (NONE)	**Runway Surface Type:**	Dirt
Airport Elevation:		**Runway Surface Condition:**	Dry
Runway Used:	26	**IFR Approach:**	None
Runway Length/Width:		**VFR Approach/Landing:**	

Wreckage and Impact Information

Crew Injuries:	1 None	**Aircraft Damage:**	Substantial
Passenger Injuries:	N/A	**Aircraft Fire:**	None
Ground Injuries:	N/A	**Aircraft Explosion:**	
Total Injuries:	1 None	**Latitude, Longitude:**	32.672222, -115.562222

Administrative Information

Investigator In Charge (IIC):	Thomas M Little	**Report Date:**	01/31/2008
Additional Participating Persons:			
Publish Date:			
Note:	This accident report documents the factual circumstances of this accident as described to the NTSB.		
Investigation Docket:	NTSB accident and incident dockets serve as permanent archival information for the NTSB's investigations. Dockets released prior to June 1, 2009 are publicly available from the NTSB's Record Management Division at pubinq@ntsb.gov, or at 800-877-6799. Dockets released after this date are available at http://dms.ntsb.gov/pubdms/.		

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The Independent Safety Board Act, as codified at 49 U.S.C. Section 1154(b), precludes the admission into evidence or use of any part of an NTSB report related to an incident or accident in a civil action for damages resulting from a matter mentioned in the report. A factual report that may be admissible under 49 U.S.C. § 1154(b) is available here.